



DRESS TROUSERS

COLLIN STOCKMOE
PERSONAL PROJECT

NOVEMBER 2025 - DECEMBER 2025



GUIDE

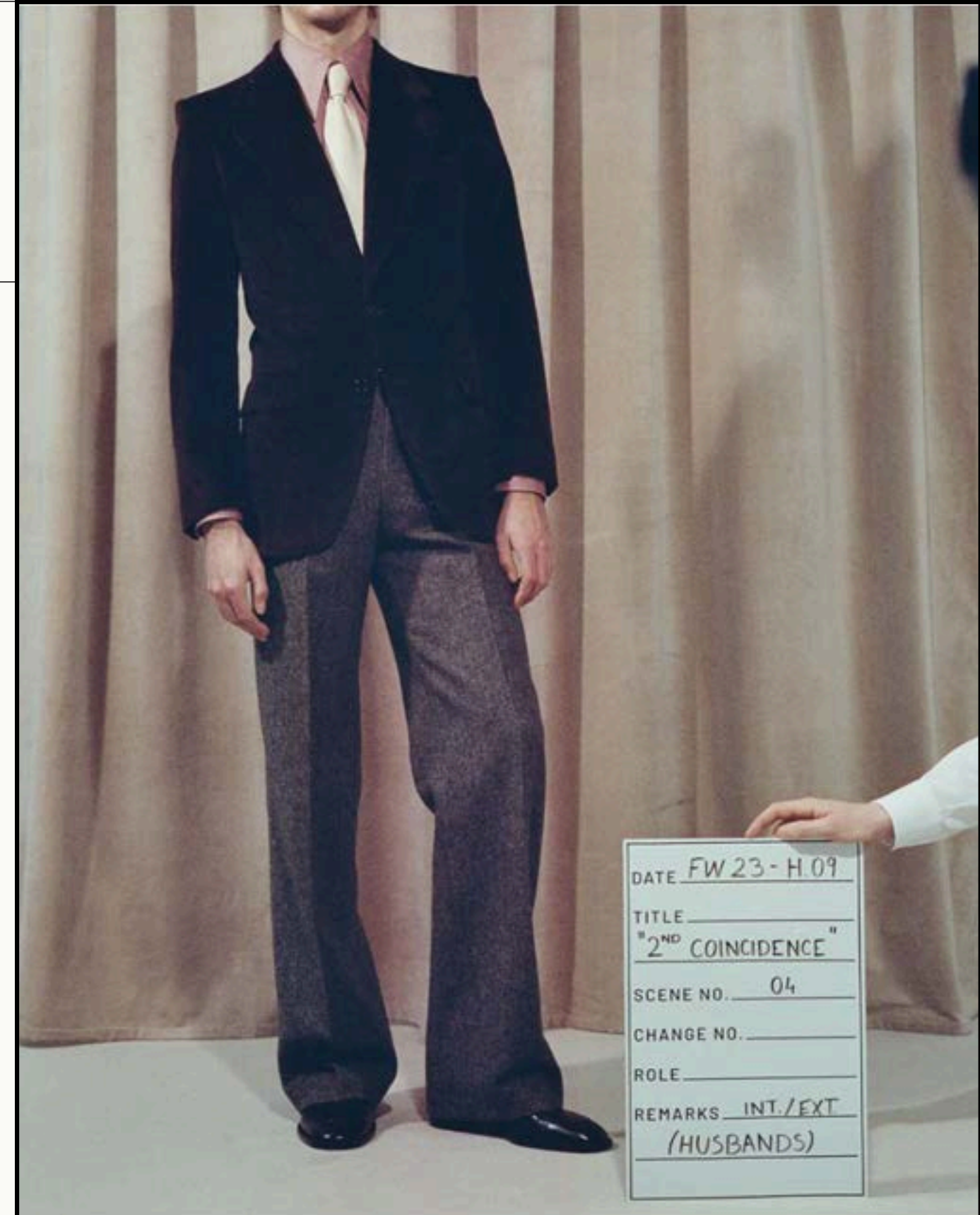
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THE OBJECTIVE

The objective behind this project was to challenge my technical patternmaking and sewing skills by developing a fully handmade and personal pair of dress trousers, with a focus on fit refinement, controlled drape, and attention to detail. Beyond wearability, the project focuses on understanding how pattern-level decisions directly influence garment geometry, drape, and final execution.

INSPIRATION

For this project, I was drawn to the work of Richard Gabard of the French atelier Husbands. Gabard's approach to menswear prioritizes structure, proportion, and discipline within his own lines of expression. His designs operate firmly within the established rules of classic tailoring, with an emphasis on balance, fit, and construction, yet his work still feels distinctive through subtle manipulation of pattern, silhouette, and material choice. What appeals to me most is how his work demonstrates that individuality in menswear does not come from breaking the rules, but from understanding them deeply enough to refine and reinterpret them with precision and restraint.



VISUAL INSPIRATION



MATERIALS

Main Fabric - For the primary fabric, my main goal was a good drape. For a wider leg pant, the drape is essential, and can make or break how the seat looks and feels on the body. I decided on a black 85% Wool / 15% Poly Gabardine for its refined drape, smooth surface, and strong press retention, all of which are central to classic tailored trousers. The gabardine weave supports clean lines through the leg while maintaining a timeless, structured appearance associated with traditional menswear.

Liner Fabric - For the lining, I chose a 100% cotton liner fabric from Bias Bespoke. While tightly woven for durability, it's not a very thick fabric which allowed it to not poke through the outside of the garment.

Buttons & Zipper - For classic menswear, there is really only one choice of button-- horn. Horn buttons are so good because they have natural weight and variation, last forever, and resist heat during pressing. A 7" bronze YKK zipper was used for its reliable performance, smooth operation, and durability, chosen in a bronze finish to complement the classic tailoring aesthetic of the trousers.



PATTERN-MAKING RESOURCES:

WINIFRED ALDRICH, METRIC PATTERN CUTTING FOR MENSWEAR

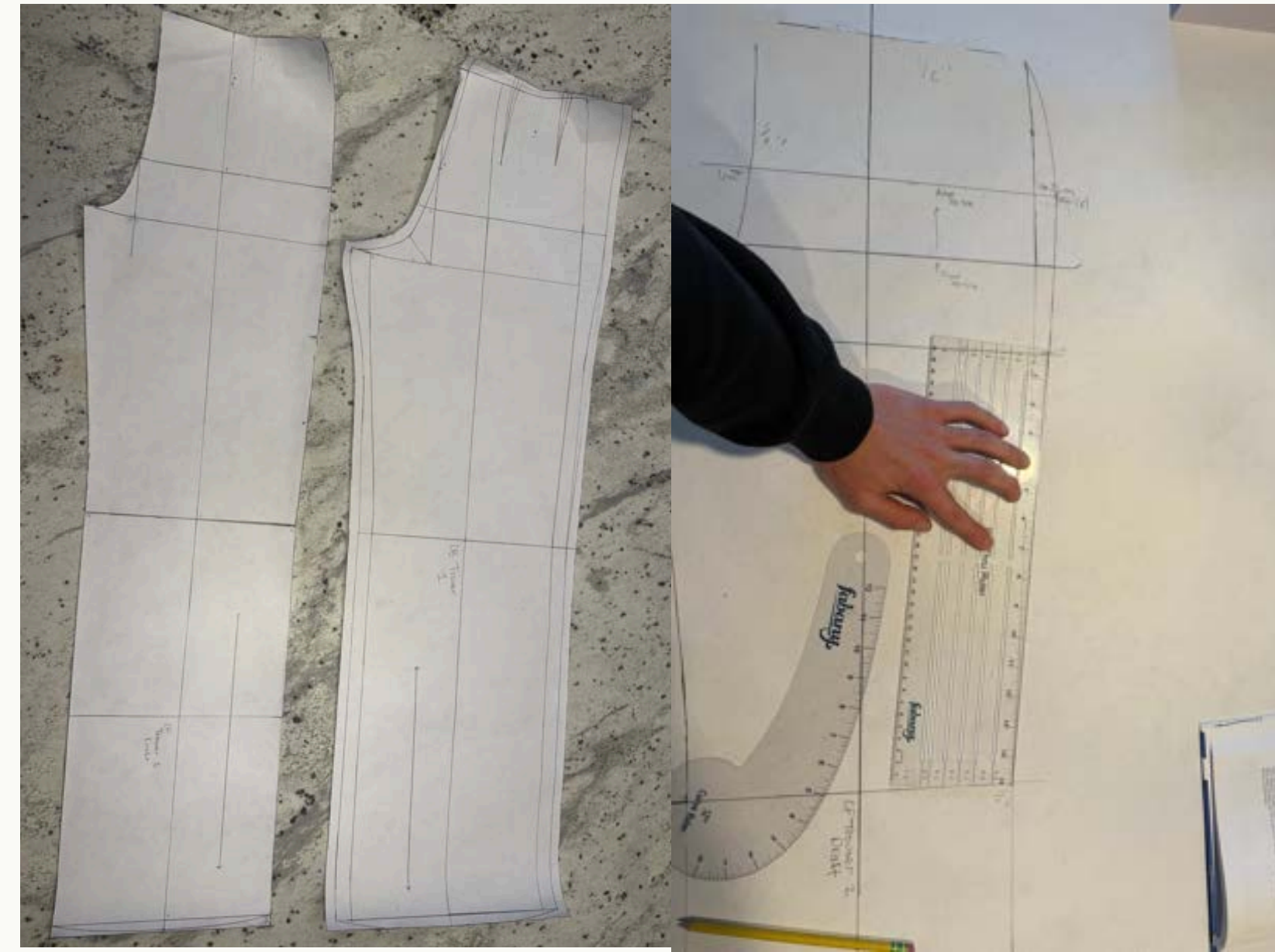
ARMSTRONG, HELEN JOSEPH. PATTERNMAKING FOR FASHION DESIGN

CABRERA & MEYERS, CLASSIC TAILORING TECHNIQUES FOR MENSWEAR

PATTERN DEVELOPMENT - DRAFT 1

This project begins and ends with the pattern. To begin, I drafted a rough sloper, and I wanted to incorporate three things--generous ease throughout the hips and seat, a high rise, and a wide leg opening.

The goal here was not a perfect pattern, rather a close enough baseline that could be altered within the next draft. Visualizing ease and rise is simple when thinking pure measurements, but naturally changes when actually drafted on the body.



DRAFT 1 - FIT NOTES

The first draft achieved a strong rise and accurate waist fit; however, the pattern lacked sufficient ease through the seat and upper thigh, resulting in tension and uneven drape below the seat. The drafted hipline sat lower than the true hip, which further disrupted the balance and flow of the trouser. Adjustments focused on correcting hip placement, improving seat drape, and refining waist shaping.



DRAFT 2 & ALTERATIONS

Pattern Revisions for Draft 2

1. Raised center-back waist slope by 1.5 cm to improve seat balance and overall rise shape.
2. Redrew hipline and added 2 cm total volume to the fixed hipline at the sideseam to allow the fabric to drape cleanly over the seat.
3. Redrafted front and back darts to align with the corrected hipline; darts measure 1.5 cm width $\times$ 12 cm length.
4. Expand knee-line and leg opening 2cm to ensure proper straight leg fit after altering the seat.



DRAFT 2 - ON BODY



DRAFT 2 - FIT NOTES

Draft 2 achieved the intended drape and balance through the seat, hip, and leg, and was largely successful in terms of overall silhouette. However, raising the waist and expanding the side seams introduced excess circumference at the waistline, resulting in noticeable gaping at the top edge. All other areas of the pattern performed as intended.

Pattern Refinement for Draft 3

- Removed approximately 10 cm total from the waist circumference.
- Increased dart intake to 1.25 cm per dart for 5cm total intake to concentrate shaping at the waist without disrupting hip drape.
- Removed 1.25 cm at CF & CB side seam, removed 2.5 cm at center back to rebalance waist suppression evenly.
- No reduction was made at center front besides the side seam.

DRAFT 3 - ON BODY



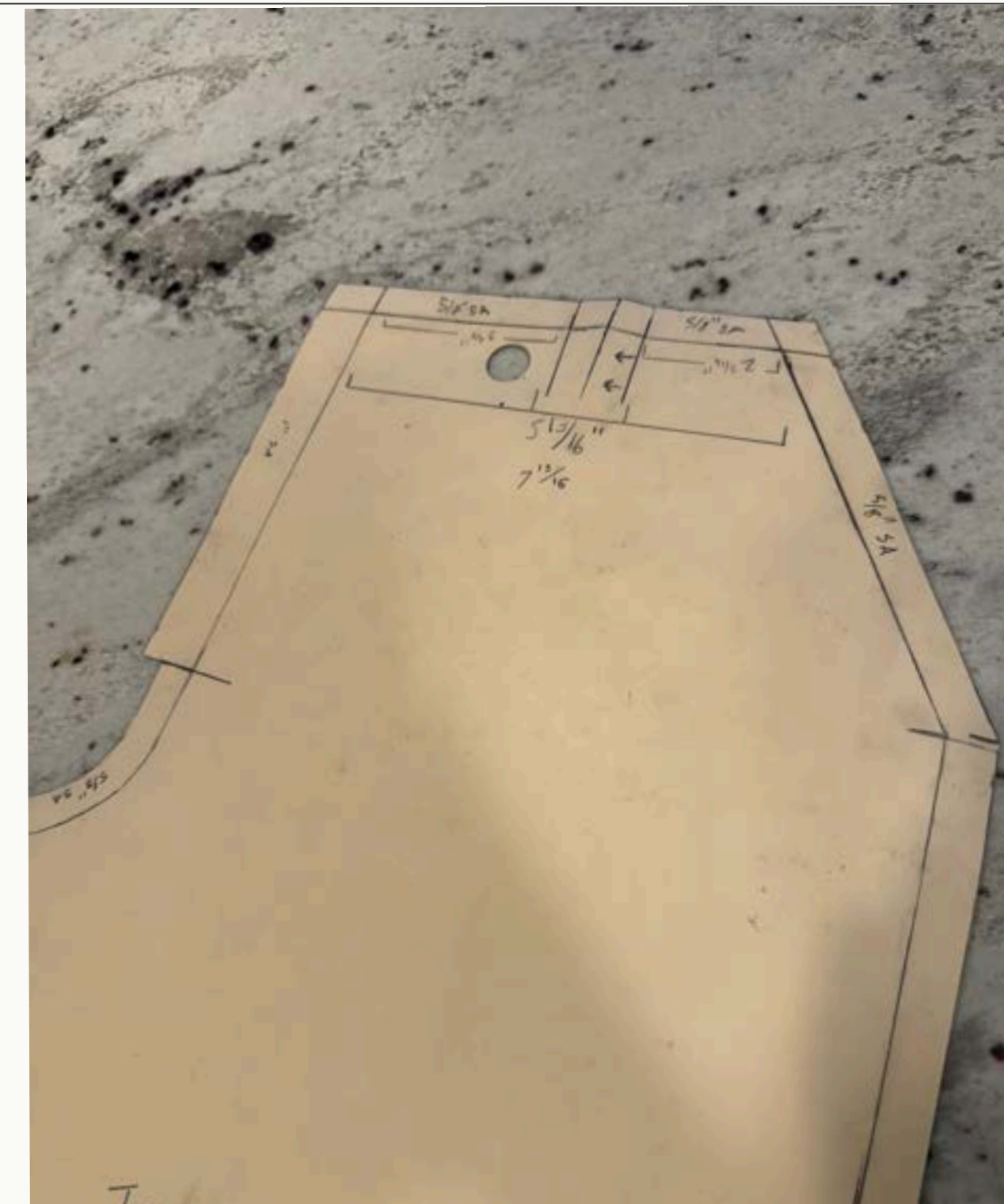
FINAL PATTERN DEVELOPMENT

Draft 3 was able to lock in any issues seen in previous drafts. The waist fit perfect, ease was well distributed, and I was ready to move on to drafting my final pattern and accessory components. While I had the basic blocks configured, now it was time to move into the pieces which turn a draft into a true trouser.

Next steps, in order:

1. Draft CF components from draft 3. This includes side-slash pockets, front pleats, and fly and fly components.
2. Draft CB components from draft 3. Primary focus are the back welt pockets.
3. Transfer draft 3 to finalized pattern paper, incorporating all darts, pleats, pockets, and any drill holes necessary.
4. Draft waistband and belt loops from finalized patterns.
5. Add seam allowance. 5/8" along all main panels, 1" along the fly. 1/4" along pocket facing. 1" along hem, double rolled.

FINAL PATTERN - CF & CB



FINAL PATTERN - COMPONENTS

Belt Loops



Belt Loops - I decided to opt for belt loops that were $\frac{3}{8}$ " wide, $1\frac{3}{4}$ " long. For a waistband that is $1\frac{1}{2}$ " thick, this felt optimal.

Front Pocket Bags - 3 piece construction with pocket facing and two bags. These pockets run 8" deep, which allow for more than enough storage for everyday items.

Waistband - $1\frac{1}{2}$ " thick, double sided. I added extra on the extension to be later trimmed down in construction.

Fly - Typical for a high rise, this fly is $7\frac{1}{4}$ " to fit a 7" zipper. Fly guard is $8\frac{1}{2}$ ".

GARMENT CONSTRUCTION

This construction of this garment took up about 3 days from start to finish. For finishings, I opted for an overlocked edge along the side seams, inseams, pocket bags. The pockets, welts, and fly feature bar-tacks in order to keep the structure clean. Further, the waistband, back welts, and fly were all interfaced prior to construction.

Primary construction flow -

1. Construct CF and all components
2. Construct CB and all components
3. Connect CF & CB
4. Attach waistband, attach belt loops, attach button & buttonhole
5. Hem & carefully press



THE RESULT

